

RACE WEEK CHECKLIST

7 DAYS. ONE SHOT.

RUNNER

Half Marathon

Everything you need to do — and not do — in the seven days before your race. Fill this in Sunday night. Carry it to the start line.

RACE NAME

RACE DATE

GOAL TIME

GOAL PACE / MILE

START TIME

CORRAL / WAVE

HOW TO USE THIS

- 01** Fill in your race details above before Sunday of race week. Calculate your goal pace using the **Run1% Pace Calculator** at run1percent.com.
- 02** Work through each day's checklist the night before or morning of. Check each box as you complete it.
- 03** The **focus cue** on each page is the one thing worth remembering that day. Read it before bed.

— 7 DAYS TO RACE —

SUNDAY

Last full training week is done. This is the start of yours.

DATE

FORECAST

TEMP ---°

RAIN Y / N

RUN

- ☐ **Easy 30-40 min shakeout** OPTIONAL
No watch targets. Conversational pace only. This is movement, not training.
- ☐ **4-6 strides after your run** RECOMMENDED
20 seconds at 5K effort. Full rest between. Wakes the legs up without adding fatigue.

LOGISTICS

- ☐ **Confirm race packet pickup time and location** CRITICAL
Do not leave this for Saturday morning.
- ☐ **Confirm parking or transit plan** CRITICAL
Account for race-day road closures. Add 30 min buffer minimum.
- ☐ **Review the course map** DO THIS
Know where mile 6, 9, and 12 are. Know the final turn. This matters more than you think.
- ☐ **Check race-day weather forecast** CHECK
Adjust gear decisions if temp is above 60°F or rain is likely.

BODY

- ☐ **Hydrate consistently all day** DAILY
Not a one-time chug. Sip water through the full day, especially if you ran.
- ☐ **Normal eating — no major dietary changes** DAILY
This is not the week to try a new diet or skip meals. Familiar food, familiar portions.
- ☐ **In bed by ___:___** SLEEP
Sleep this week matters. Friday night probably won't — bank sleep now.

FOCUS CUE — SUNDAY

The training is done. Every mile, every early morning, every hard session — it's already in the bank. This week your only job is to arrive fresh.

NOTES

— 6 DAYS TO RACE —

MONDAY

Full rest or very easy movement. Resist the urge to add mileage.

DATE

FORECAST

TEMP ---°

RAIN Y / N

RUN

☐

Rest day — or 20-25 min walk

Do not run if your plan calls for rest. Walking is fine. Sitting is fine. A jog is not.

REST

GEAR — START YOUR AUDIT

☐

Locate race shoes — inspect for wear

These should have 50-150 miles on them. Not brand new. Not worn out.

CRITICAL

☐

Find your race-day socks

Socks you've run in before. Nothing new.

CHECK

☐

Locate your GPS watch + charging cable

Charge it tonight. Don't wait until Saturday.

CHECK

☐

Confirm you have BodyGlide or anti-chafe

Thighs, underarms, anywhere your kit rubs. You will not enjoy mile 10 without this.

CHECK

☐

Inventory your race nutrition

How many gels? Do you have the ones you trained with? Count them now.

CRITICAL

BODY

☐

Begin carb-loading baseline

Not a pasta-binge — just make sure you're eating enough carbohydrates today and tomorrow.

NUTRITION

☐

Avoid alcohol this week

Even one drink affects sleep quality and hydration. Save it for post-race.

BODY

FOCUS CUE — MONDAY

The urge to add one more run is the taper talking, not your body. Rest is training. Sit with it.

NOTES

- 5 DAYS TO RACE -

TUESDAY

Short easy run. The last real training stimulus before race day.

DATE

FORECAST

TEMP ---°

RAIN Y / N

PLANNED DISTANCE

--- MI

ACTUAL DISTANCE

--- MI

AVG PACE

:--

EFFORT (1-5)

RUN

☐

20-30 min easy run

Fully conversational. No splits targets. Stop if something feels off.

EASY

☐

4 strides after the run

20 sec pickups at race pace or slightly faster. Keeps the legs sharp.

STRIDES

GEAR - CONTINUE AUDIT

☐

Decide on race-day kit - top, shorts/tights, bra

Everything worn race day must have been worn in training. No exceptions.

CRITICAL

☐

Decide on hat / visor / headband

Check forecast. Have a rain plan and a heat plan.

DECIDE

☐

Plan your throwaway warm layer

An old hoodie or garbage bag for the corral. You will drop it at the start.

GEAR

RACE STRATEGY

☐

Write down your mile 1 pace target

It should be 10-15 sec/mi slower than goal pace. Write it. Don't rely on memory at mile 1 with adrenaline flooding your system.

CRITICAL

☐

Plan your gel timing

Miles 5 and 9 is standard for a half. Pre-open them in your belt if possible.

STRATEGY

FOCUS CUE - TUESDAY

Every phantom twinge you feel this week is taper paranoia, not injury. Your body is absorbing months of work. This is what it feels like.

NOTES / HOW THE RUN FELT

– 4 & 3 DAYS TO RACE –

WED / THU

DATES

The quiet days. Routine, sleep, and staying off your feet.

WEDNESDAY – 4 DAYS OUT

- ☐ Rest or 20 min easy walk only REST
- ☐ Charge GPS watch fully CRITICAL
100%. Don't start Saturday with 60%.
- ☐ Check race bib pickup is confirmed CHECK
- ☐ Sleep priority: in bed by __:__ CRITICAL
This is the most important sleep night of the week. Thursday sleep bank matters more than Friday.

THURSDAY – 3 DAYS OUT

- ☐ 15-20 min very easy run + 4 strides OPTIONAL
Optional. Only if you feel flat. Strides keep the legs from going completely stale.
- ☐ Pick up race bib (if expo is today) LOGISTICS
- ☐ Avoid standing for long periods BODY
Race expos are the enemy of fresh legs. Walk the expo, get your bib, leave.
- ☐ Plan Thursday dinner – familiar carb-heavy meal NUTRITION
Pasta, rice, bread – your standard pre-run food. Not a new restaurant.
- ☐ Begin pre-hydration – electrolytes + water HYDRATION
Liquid IV or similar with your evening meal. Sip water through the day.

FOCUS CUE – WEDNESDAY & THURSDAY

The sleep you get Thursday night matters more than Friday night. Pre-race nerves will disrupt Friday. Bank rest now while you can still sleep.

NOTES

- 2 DAYS TO RACE -

FRIDAY

DATE

RACE DAY FORECAST

TEMP ---°

WIND Y / N

Gear finalized. Bag packed. Nothing left to decide.

GEAR - FINAL PREP

- ☐ Lay out complete race-day kit CRITICAL
Shoes, socks, shorts/tights, top, bra, hat/visor, belt, headphones (if using). Everything in one pile.
- ☐ Load gels into race belt / kit pockets CRITICAL
Pre-open the top tear if possible. Practice this. You will not want to fumble at mile 5.
- ☐ BodyGlide applied - or set next to kit for morning GEAR
- ☐ Throwaway warm layer ready for corral GEAR
- ☐ Race bib - confirm you have it, pin or clip to kit CRITICAL
- ☐ Watch alarm set for race morning: __:___ CRITICAL
Give yourself 2 hours minimum before start time. 90 min is not enough.

RACE MORNING PLAN - FINALIZE TONIGHT

- ☐ Breakfast decided: _____ CRITICAL
What you've eaten before every long run. Nothing new. Eat 2-2.5 hours before start.
- ☐ Transportation confirmed: _____ LOGISTICS
- ☐ Corral / start area arrival time: __:___ LOGISTICS
Aim for 20-30 min before your wave. Warm-up time matters.

WATCH SETUP

- ☐ Set pace alert for mile 1: _:_ /mi CRITICAL
Goal pace minus 10-15 sec. If the watch buzzes, you're going out too fast.
- ☐ Turn on auto-lap every 1 mile WATCH

FOCUS CUE - FRIDAY

Everything left to decide gets decided tonight. Tomorrow is execution, not planning. Lay out your kit, set your alarm, and go to bed early.

— 1 DAY TO RACE —

SATURDAY

DATE

The only job today is staying off your feet and out of your head.

MOVEMENT

- ☐

Do not run today

CRITICAL

No exceptions. A 20-minute walk maximum if you feel stir-crazy. Legs stay fresh.
-
- ☐

Avoid standing for long periods

BODY

Couch, chair, horizontal. Every hour on your feet costs something at mile 10.

NUTRITION

- ☐

Consistent carbohydrates all day — familiar food only

CRITICAL

Rice, pasta, bread, potatoes. No heavy fat or high fiber. No new restaurants.
-
- ☐

Dinner by 6-7pm — nothing heavy after

NUTRITION

Familiar pre-race meal. Done early. Your gut needs time to settle.
-
- ☐

Hydrate with electrolytes through the day

HYDRATION

Sip consistently. Don't chug. You want to wake up tomorrow already ahead.
-
- ☐

No alcohol

CRITICAL

MENTAL PREP

- ☐

Review course map one more time — know the final mile

STRATEGY
-
- ☐

Write your mile 1 target pace on your hand or a card

CRITICAL

_:__ / mi. Non-negotiable ceiling for the first mile.
-
- ☐

Stay off running forums and social media

MENTAL

Nothing good happens in a runner's brain 24 hours before a race on the internet.

NIGHT BEFORE

- ☐

Final kit check — everything out and ready

CRITICAL
-
- ☐

Alarm confirmed: __:__

CRITICAL
-
- ☐

In bed by __:__ — phone away

SLEEP

You probably won't sleep great. That's normal and fine. Just lie still.

TODAY IS THE DAY

RACE DAY

Trust the training. Run the plan. Finish strong.

DATE

CONDITIONS

TEMP ___°

WIND ___

MORNING ROUTINE

- ☐ Wake: ___:___ - Breakfast immediately
- Eat 2-2.5 hours before your wave start. What you've eaten before every long run.
- CRITICAL
- ☐ Hydrate: 16 oz water + electrolytes with breakfast
- Sip, don't chug. Stop 45 min before start to avoid porta-potty issues.
- HYDRATION
- ☐ Apply BodyGlide - everywhere
- CRITICAL
- ☐ Confirm kit: bib, gels, watch, socks, shoes
- CRITICAL

PRE-RACE

- ☐ Arrive at start area by ___:___
- 20-30 min before wave. Time to warm up, porta-potties, settle in.
- LOGISTICS
- ☐ 10 min easy jog + 3-4 strides before start
- Especially important for half marathons - race pace comes quickly. Don't start cold.
- WARMUP
- ☐ Mile 1 pace written on hand / memorized: _:_
- CRITICAL
- ☐ Gel timing plan confirmed: Mile ___ and Mile ___
- STRATEGY

MILES 1-4

Controlled. It will feel easy. That is the plan working. Trust it.

MILES 5-9

Settle into goal pace. Take gel at mile ___. Steady effort.

MILES 10-11

This is where it gets hard. This is where you find out what the training built.

MILES 12-13.1

Everything left. Empty the tank. You will not regret it at the finish line.

— RACE COMPLETE —

POST RACE

Log it while it's fresh. You'll want this later.

RACE DATE

RESULTS

OFFICIAL TIME	AVG PACE	CHIP VS GOAL	OVERALL PLACE

MILE SPLITS

MI 1	MI 2	MI 3	MI 4	MI 5	MI 6	MI 7
MI 8	MI 9	MI 10	MI 11	MI 12	MI 13	.1

RACE DEBRIEF

WHAT WENT WELL

WHAT I'D DO DIFFERENTLY

NEXT RACE / GOAL

MORE TOOLS AT RUN1PERCENT.COM